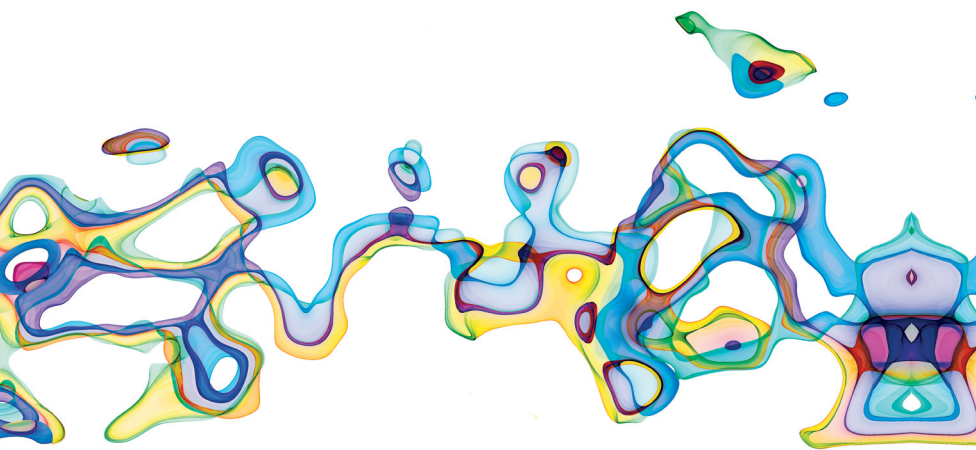


THE NEW SCIENCE OF
LIVING A LONGER, HEALTHIER,
MORE VITAL LIFE

QUANTUM BODY



Deepak Chopra with
Jack Tuszynski & Brian Fertig



Praise for *Quantum Body*

“Almost forty years ago, Deepak Chopra launched a revolution in alternative medicine with his book *Quantum Healing*. It was a time when meditation and the concept of a mind-body connection were considered fringe ideas. Today, dozens of years and dozens of books later, that fringe has become mainstream. In *Quantum Body*, Chopra picks up where his earlier book left off to present a plan for a happier and healthier life. Though I do not subscribe to all his theoretical points, his practical advice is as wise and potent as ever.”

—Leonard Mlodinow, physicist and bestselling author of *Stephen Hawking: A Memoir of Friendship and Physics* and *Emotional: How Feelings Shape Our Thinking*

“Deepak Chopra has taken heat from skeptics like me for his riffs on quantum theory. But I found his latest book, which links the quantum realm to our innate powers of self-healing and spiritual growth, inspiring.”

—John Horgan, science journalist and director of the Stevens Center for Science Writings at the Stevens Institute of Technology

“*Quantum Body* is a bold and brilliant integration of quantum science and ancient wisdom, providing us with a deep and expansive understanding of our mind-body, how interconnected we are, and implications for our health. Chopra, Tuszynski, and Fertig provide easy and satisfying tips for becoming intimate with our ‘quantum body,’ allowing us to turn off our autopilot stress mode, and immerse in our presence and the larger reality we are part of.”

—Elissa Epel, PhD, professor at UCSF, coauthor of *New York Times* bestseller *The Telomere Effect: A Revolutionary Approach to Living Younger, Healthier, Longer*, and author of *The Stress Prescription*

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“The crystal-clear words in this original and fearless book makes the case for the mystery of the quantum field’s activity in our living realm of quantum biology and its relevance to the human experience and wellness.”

—Stephon Alexander, professor of physics at
Brown University, former president of the
National Society of Black Physicists (NSBP)

“Allied with an emergent cosmology of an essentially living and meaningful Universe, this revelatory and timely book is a profound guide to empower our collective healing and conscious evolution.”

—Jude Currivan, PhD, cosmologist, author of
The Cosmic Hologram and *The Story of Gaia*, and
cofounder of WholeWorld-View

“*Quantum Body* brings readers up to date on what the latest science says about quantum biology and its application to medicine.”

—Michael Shermer, publisher *Skeptical* magazine,
Presidential Fellow at Chapman University, and
author of *Heavens on Earth*

“An excellent, reader-friendly book that will leave you feeling inspired.”

—Amit Goswami, PhD, quantum physicist and coauthor of
The Quantum Brain, *The Quantum Reenchantment of the
Reality You Live*, and *Quantum Integrative Medicine*

“Chopra, Tuszynski, and Fertig dispel dichotomous thinking and, through provocative questioning, lead the reader to personalized enlightenment.”

—Jeffrey I. Mechanick, MD, professor of medicine at
Icahn School of Medicine at Mount Sinai, New York City

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“Drs. Chopra, Tuszynski, and Fertig present a profound vision of life that offers us a radically integrative understanding of our bodies, our consciousness, and our place in the universe. Melding medical science, quantum physics, and spiritual wisdom, this book will bring you to ‘aha’ moments that will forever change the way you experience yourself and the world.”

—Robert Waldinger, MD, clinical professor of psychiatry at Harvard Medical School, director of the Center for Psychodynamic Therapy and Research at Massachusetts General Hospital, and director of the Harvard Study of Adult Development

“Your body is a ripple in the quantum field. Your body is a miracle in the quantum field; and the quantum field is a miracle in the quantum universe. This is what this book is telling you. After reading *Quantum Body*, you will never treat your body in the same way again. You will treat it with the care and respect a genuine miracle deserves. Your life and health will testify to the difference. And for the new you and its sanity, you will have this milestone book by Deepak Chopra and his colleagues to thank.”

—Ervin Laszlo, author of *Science and the Akashic Field* and *The Upshift*

‘Highly practical advice on how we can shift our sense of reality to achieve an entirely new level of whole-body wellness based on concepts of quantum physics and the fundamental nature of consciousness.’

—Rudolph E. Tanzi, PhD, Joseph P. and Rose F. Kennedy Professor of Neurology, Harvard Medical School

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‘*Quantum Body* is, at the very least, an intriguing work that cannot be cavalierly dismissed. And its relevance to our lives cannot be overestimated.’

—Bernardo Kastrup, PhD, author, philosopher, and
computer scientist; Executive Director,
Essentia Foundation

‘Defly weaves recent discoveries from physics and biology with ancient insights from spirituality to provide practical advice for maintaining a healthy body and a balanced mind.’

—Donald D. Hoffman, PhD,
Professor of Cognitive Sciences,
University of California, Irvine;
author of *The Case Against Reality*

‘*Quantum Body* is a rare exposition of truths, a work of deep knowledge, practical steps for life as well as reality in its most encompassing aspect.’

—Menas C. Kafatos, PhD, Fletcher Jones Endowed
Professor of Computational Physics and Director,
Institute for Earth, Computing, Human, and Observing
(ECHO), Chapman University

Quantum Body

The New Science of Living a
Longer, Healthier, More Vital Life

Deepak Chopra

Jack Tuszynski

Brian Fertig



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Quantum Body

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Preface

by Deepak Chopra

This book celebrates the most surprising turn my life took, which happened more than thirty years ago. I had a medical practice in Boston that was hectic to the point of exhaustion. I took up meditation to alleviate the constant wear and tear of my life. It worked, but there was an unexpected side effect. I became a writer. With no background but bountiful enthusiasm, I was enjoying modest success when out of the blue I had a life-changing idea.

It sprang to mind as a visual image, which showed the human body shimmering with light and energy. This wasn't a medically respectable vision. At some level it made sense, however, and after some inner searching, I had a breakthrough. What I saw was the quantum mechanical body. I had a strong bent for science, and I knew that every physical object has its source in the quantum field. This included

the human body. Behind the appearance of blood coursing through our veins, the suppleness of skin, and the mysterious electrical storm shattering the silence of the brain, we are quantum creations. Our essence begins as ripples in the quantum field, a fact that is inescapable.

I found it thrilling, and since I had another bent—for out-of-the-box thinking—the prospects of crossing the quantum horizon fascinated me. None of my medical colleagues would have supported me. We're harking back to a time when even the mind-body connection was considered questionable. The term wasn't taught in medical school, where even the medical benefits of meditation were considered a fringe topic.

The product of my medically weird thinking was a book, *Quantum Healing*, which gave me my first boost into being noticed. The book was a success and with success came a mix of positive and negative results. For mainstream doctors, my venture into mind-body medicine was either embarrassing, cocky, or professionally suicidal. Where I gained encouragement was in the meditation and spiritual community, alongside the field of alternative medicine, which was still struggling for acceptance.

Their struggle became mine. Thirty-seven years later, the fringe has moved to the center. Meditation, the mind-body connection, and alternative medicine (which ex-

panded to become integrative, or complementary, medicine) no longer raise eyebrows. New studies are overturning long-held mainstream medical beliefs, and future horizons look bright.

Even so, it seemed like the right time to take a second bite of the apple. The quantum world is alien and strange. Its connection to the human body baffles people. It would be almost impossible to find someone qualified to write about medicine and quantum reality. But, by great good fortune, I found two scientists with exactly those qualifications. Jack Tuszynski, PhD, is a physics professor and Brian Fertig, MD, an endocrinologist and medical-school professor. Together, they have a wealth of insights into a new and exciting field—quantum biology. Their research papers break new ground, bolstering the science that supports the reality of the quantum body.

As often as the phrase *cutting-edge* is used, there are revolutionary implications in quantum biology, because until very recently, a Chinese wall separated the quantum domain from the vastly larger scale of cells and living creatures that biology studies. Bringing the two worlds together stirs me with fascination. This book puts you in the forefront of a revolution that promises to alter everything we know about the human body.

Thirty years ago, I knew that *Quantum Healing* was just

the beginning of the story. It has taken all this time to reveal many findings that were only hinted at until medical science, physics, and biology caught up. In *Quantum Body*, this new knowledge is hot off the presses, you might say, even though science proceeds cautiously when it comes to new breakthroughs. The quantum body is a newborn, but my innovative coauthors and I are certain it is here to stay.

OVERVIEW

Meet Your Quantum Body

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As is the human body, so is the cosmic body.
As is the human mind, so is the cosmic mind.

—ANCIENT UPANISHAD

Your body isn't what you think it is. Or, to be more precise, your *real* body isn't what you think it is. That's because your real body cannot be seen in the mirror. It doesn't get sick or grow old. It doesn't fit inside the package of flesh and bones that occupies a few cubic feet in time and space. Very little about your real body is talked about in medical textbooks, and when medical students learn anatomy by dissecting the physical body, they never touch your real body, much less peer inside it with their scalpels.

Your real body is a quantum creation. It rises from the same quantum field that created the universe, but in your case, the act of creation is constant and new every second. Your genesis is here and now. This isn't news to your cells. Their connection to the quantum domain is

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indisputable. Every thought you have requires your brain cells to exchange electrical signals, and electricity is quantum, being part of the electromagnetic field. You are a quantum creation even if you don't realize it, because every cell, not just brain cells, emits a self-generated electric field. If this field goes dark, the cell has died.

Beyond these basic facts, your body's electrical field, sometimes known as the biofield, connects you to some rich and unknown possibilities. The electrical impulses inside your brain aren't random. There's not a crackling storm of microscopic lightning in your brain but an organized process. Somehow, the brain's electrical impulses *know what they are doing*. When you want to have a thought, words appear in your head; you don't hear static or the white noise that random frequencies would generate. To imagine the mystery behind this, think of living in a house where electricity flows through the wiring and decides to operate all your appliances any way it wants to.

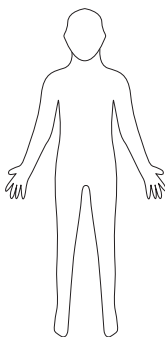
That's an impossibility when it comes to household electricity, but as you read this sentence, the words mean something because the biofield flickers with meaningful activity. Now expand the picture. Not just individual cells or clumps of cells, not even whole organs like the heart and brain, but your entire body is held together by mean-

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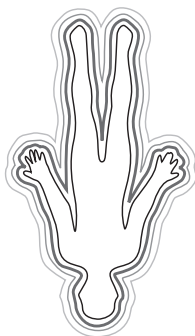
ingful activity. Every cell knows what it is meant to do. It has even been proposed that the biofield is actually an *electrome*, a totality like your genome. Your genome is an encyclopedia of the knowledge contained in all 20,000 to 25,000 genes in the human body. Geneticists are constantly delving into the information coded in human DNA, but it would be impossible to approach your electrome the same way. Genes can be viewed under a microscope. Electrical impulse are invisible ripples or fluctuations in the biofield. Genes are stable—the ones you were born with remain fixed for a lifetime—but electrical impulses are in constant flux. No two seconds of your life so far have contained the same map of activity in your electrome.

This brief sketch indicates that you possess a quantum body already in a single dimension. Much more is happening at the quantum level than electrical signals. There's a psychological dimension to quantum reality that needs to be explored, and a spiritual dimension that brings wonder and insight to the human condition. These dimensions are beautiful, but they will have to wait. For now, we need to understand the basic nature of the quantum body. The illustration below shows the setup in outline form, where physical reality exists above the line and quantum reality below it.

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Physical Body

Quantum Body

To use the accepted scientific terms, a physicist would refer to the world above the line as the *macroscopic* world, meaning the world of objects bigger than an atom. The quantum world is on the edge of being physical but is much, much smaller than the macroscopic world. The scale is almost unimaginably small.

In the everyday world, your physical body has a definite shape while your quantum body is blurry—it merges into the quantum field, which is infinite in all directions. At the finest level, all physical objects, including your body, dissolve into a haze of energy clouds. At an even finer level, these clouds lose their edges entirely, become shapeless, and vanish as invisible ripples in the quantum field.

Beyond this vanishing act, what is so astonishing is that everyday reality is controlled from the quantum level. Your physical body is like the leaves and twigs of a plant rooted out of sight belowground. If you water the leaves and twigs while ignoring the roots, the plant will die. The analogy holds true for the body as well, which owes its existence to the surge of energy from the quantum world.

Don't be intimidated by the technical word *quantum* and its application in modern physics. It is enough to know one thing: Your true source—the origin of who you are—exists at the finest level of Nature, which is the quantum field. The fact that you occupy time and space is a quantum event. So is the existence of the matter and energy of your physical makeup.

You have been navigating the quantum field all your life, and this journey is all-important. The body you see in the mirror cannot exist outside the quantum field; neither can your thoughts, feelings, or sensations. *If you want to*

solve the most troubling issues about having a human body, especially disease and aging, the answers lie only at the source. The same is true of mental and psychological issues, from anxiety and depression to Alzheimer's disease. The reason these mysteries remain unsolved is due to limited vision. We have failed to look beyond flesh and blood to their origin.

Expand your vision, and new truths emerge. Here is the first and most important one: Nothing can happen to you, for good or ill, until it happens at the quantum level. A ripple in the quantum field determines whether you feel pleasure or pain, fall in love, feel hostility, experience an "aha" moment, or think the same routine thoughts. A cancer cell becomes malignant because of a distortion in its genetic activity that occurs as a quantum event before any physical manifestation of disease.

Expanded vision reveals a second truth of the most intimate kind: Your well-being, or the lack of it, depends entirely on the quantum field. This sounds like a sweeping generalization. If you feel vibrant and alive, you might explain it any number of ways: You have healthy self-esteem; your body is fit and healthy; your relationships are loving and secure. Finances, success at work, and even the weather contribute their part. But these separate elements have the same source, the quantum field. And the quantum body is

your portion of the field, the part you call “me” in body, mind, and spirit.

We are offering a revolutionary perspective here, and in the pages that follow we will further explain what the quantum body really is and how to make it a daily reality. But the need for a new model of the human body is urgent. The existing model has run into many unsolved mysteries. Setting aside the ongoing struggle against disease and aging, the simple mechanics of the body are totally inexplicable. Consider some basic facts.

At this moment, your physical body is like a snapshot that exists only for an instant before everything that is you moves on, leaving the picture behind as a discarded image. The you that you see in a selfie no longer exists. Inside every cell, a thousand processes have changed in the time it took you to read this sentence. In the same instant, your brain fired in unpredictable patterns woven within its quadrillion connections. Billions of oxygen molecules entered your bloodstream while billions of molecules of carbon dioxide departed. The simple fact that you shed 20 million skin cells a day points to the transitory nature of life.

The current model of the human body is overwhelmed by such bewildering complexity. At every level—physical, mental, emotional, and beyond—constant change keeps

surging forward, and 99.999 percent of this change is occurring automatically. You are either benefiting from change or being damaged by it.

This is the crux of well-being. So much is happening automatically that trying to push things in a positive direction seems impossible, like trying to catch the water from a rainstorm one drop at a time. Even with all the medical advances that revolve around the human genome, the wellness movement remains stuck in the old model. Lifelong well-being has run into serious obstacles, including the following:

- No matter how good your diet is, you have no control over what happens to the food once it enters your digestive tract.
- No matter how positive your thoughts, you have no control over how your thoughts interact with a lifetime of stored memories, which are the relics of your past thoughts.
- No matter how perfectly the human brain is understood, you cannot predict your next desire, wish, fear, insight, or memory. Once any of these impulses arises, it has already vanished before the next impulse appears.

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That's barely a thumbnail sketch of why our view of well-being needs to be revolutionized. Consider everything else that modern medicine says you can't control—your immune response, the activity of your genes, the ability of cells to clear out toxins, the teeming microorganisms inside your digestive tract. Each of these areas contains a dozen mysteries, but the real mystery is how you manage to exist as a functioning human being at all.

That's the mystery this book aims to solve. *The essence of who you are, the 99.999 percent outside your conscious control, is totally under control—from the quantum level. Your quantum body holds the master switches to every function inside you.* Here is where you can find your true self. Your true self embraces body and mind as a whole. It isn't a thing with a fixed location—there is no region of the brain that creates the self. To be the real you requires the whole stream of life to course through you.

Because the quantum field is infinite, so is your quantum body. This seems inconceivable if you identify only with your physical body and its many limitations. But the truth emerges if you shift your attention to information. Anything that exists can be reduced to information, like the digital zeros and ones embedded in a computer's operating system. Your bloodstream carries billions of bits of

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information to every cell, which is impressive but still not infinite.

We get closer to infinity with the immune system. When a white cell runs into invading bacteria or viruses, what really happens is that information confronts information. If the white cell detects that the invader's genetic information matches a known threat, the invader is destroyed. The immune system stores the knowledge of who is friend or foe, going back as far as your ancestral line and even earlier to the rise of hominids and the emergence of mammals. In terms of information, a single cell invisibly encapsulates every immune response for millions of years.

Information is invisible, but, like matter and energy, it cannot be destroyed, only distorted. If you have spring allergies or hay fever, completely innocuous pollen is being misread by your immune system. "I am harmless" is read as "I am a danger," and, based on a wrong message, the allergic response kicks into overdrive. A host of defenses (primarily the histamine response, which triggers a runny nose, red eyes, congestion, and low energy) makes you suffer. The fact that these physical symptoms are based on invisible information is the reality. But where did things go wrong?

We can answer this question by knowing just one thing: Information is perfect at the quantum level. Before

it invades your body, a particle of dust or pollen is a clump of chemicals coded with information, none of which is harmful in and of itself, just as the hydrogen and oxygen in a drop of water aren't harmful.

Harmless information goes wrong somewhere along the following pathway.

Quantum Body—> ? —> Physical Body

The question mark stands for a profound mystery. Somehow, somewhere, information that starts out perfectly harmless takes a wrong turn. Why? Through a failure of intelligence. The reason the immune system is often called a “floating brain” is that each white cell contains enormous intelligence. It knows what to do. So, if it does the wrong thing—making you sneeze all day with hay fever or causing a child who is allergic to peanuts to go into anaphylactic shock, which is potentially fatal—this is a failure of intelligence. There is no difference between an immune cell mistaking the identity of a dust particle and you mistaking a face in the crowd for someone you know when the person is actually a complete stranger.

Your quantum body is the central hub for every process that requires intelligence, just as a power plant is the central hub for everything that requires electricity. The prospect of the power grid being brought down by technical

failure or sabotage is far more dreadful than the prospect of a toaster or a light bulb burning out. Likewise, the prospect of having your quantum body fail you is far more serious than any single symptom of disease and aging.

We have arrived at the two most powerful conclusions that drive this book.

Well-being is weakened whenever there is a failure of intelligence.

Well-being is strengthened when intelligence flows naturally.

When we unpack these two ideas in the following pages, you will be able to revolutionize your state of well-being from the source.

Fortunately, your quantum body knows how to take care of you and can never lose even a scrap of its intelligence. Disease and aging arise further downstream. When someone succumbs to a heart attack or cancer, intelligence has failed in one system (the cardiovascular system in the case of a heart attack) or just a single cell (the malignant cell from which cancer develops). By comparison, this is the tiniest fraction of the intelligence that keeps every cell alive.

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Now you are faced with an exciting prospect. *Instead of being anxious about cells, tissues, organs, and systems, which aren't under your control, you can live from the source where all controls are overseen by your quantum body. There, all information is perfect, the flow of intelligence is never wrong or distorted, and the creative possibilities for the future are boundless. Living from your source reveals that the infinite is personal and within reach.*

Living this new reality requires a skill set that we will teach you to master. We will erase the question mark that keeps the quantum body a mystery. By its very nature, the flow of intelligence should be unbroken. Local distortions are fixable, but this is possible only at the level of solutions, not at the level of the problem.

Rest assured that every aspect of well-being is controlled by the quantum body. Your true self awaits you there, holding out secrets beyond the realm of the imagination.

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